

Nello Esposito

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REFERENCES

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EDUCATION AND EMPLOYMENT

- **PhD Internship**, Central Bank of Ireland, Dublin *Sep 2026 - current*
Digital Euro Unit (DEU)
- **PhD in Economics**, University of Naples Federico II *Nov 2022 - Feb 2027 (expected)*
Supervisor: Tullio Jappelli
- **Visiting Student Researcher**, Stanford University *Sep 2024 - May 2025*
Host: Luigi Pistaferri
- **MA in Economics**, University of Naples Federico II *Sep 2019 - Oct 2021*
Summa cum Laude
- **Erasmus Program**, Goethe University Frankfurt *Nov 2020 - March 2021*

RESEARCH FIELDS

Household Finance, Labor Economics, Digital Euro

SELECTED WORK PAPERS

Employment Protection and Consumption: Evidence from Italy (Job Market Paper)

Leveraging an Italian labour market reform known as the *Jobs Act* (JA), I study how employment risk affects household consumption and labour supply. The JA reduced protection against individual termination only for workers hired on or after March 7, 2015, by firms with at least 15 employees. Using this time-based discontinuity in employment protection as a source of exogenous variation in employment risk, I find that workers subject to the reform consume 8% less than workers hired until

March 6, 2015, not exposed to the reform. There is, on the other hand, no significant effect on weekly hours worked. I use this empirical result to estimate a standard incomplete-markets model with ex-ante heterogeneity in employment risk. Replicating the empirical analysis in a simulated dataset and controlling for permanent income, I find that risk explains about one third of the reduced-form effect on consumption. Finally, I use the model to show that providing more generous unemployment insurance to workers exposed to the reform and less to unexposed workers, keeping the government's budget constraint fixed, maximizes welfare and reduces consumption inequality.

Retirement and Portfolio Choices: Evidence from Italian Households

(Joint with Nicol Barbieri, *University of Naples Federico II*)

This paper studies how retirement affects household portfolio allocation using rich panel data from the Italian Survey on Household Income and Wealth (SHIW) between 2012 and 2022. Exploiting exogenous variation in pension eligibility rules, we estimate a 2SLS with individual and time fixed effects to identify the causal impact of retirement on stock holdings. We find that when the head retires, households increase the share of financial wealth invested in stocks by more than 7 percentage points. This result stands in sharp contrast to standard portfolio choice theory, which predicts a decreasing equity share with age but aligns with recent evidence of a negative relationship between background risk and households' stock market participation. When people retire, they are no longer exposed to employment risk. Therefore, they can afford to "replace" their background risk with financial risk if they are not close to the liquidity constraint. The effect is driven by wealthy retirees who had a stable career without unemployment spells, while poor liquidity-constrained retirees not only do not invest more in the financial market, but also reduce their consumption upon retirement.

OTHER WORK IN PROGRESS

Retirement and the Demographic Transition: a Survey Experiment

Do individuals incorporate information about the national pension system into their retirement expectations and investment decisions? Using a novel representative sample of working Italians aged 15 to 75, this paper exploits exogenous variation in information by randomly exposing half of the sample to news about the pension system. I show that treated individuals increase, on average, their expected social security wealth by around 5%. Leveraging the Survey RCT as a first stage, I estimate the degree of substitutability between public pension wealth and private pension plans. I find very little substitutability and no significant substitutability, especially among individuals with low financial literacy.

The Impact of Real Estate Subsidies on Consumption: the Italian "Superbonus 110"

(Joint with Massimiliano Sfrogola, Bank of Italy, and University of Naples Federico II)

RESEARCH AND TEACHING EXPERIENCE

RESEARCH

- **November 2021 - October 2022** Research Assistant, University of Naples Federico II
PI: Tullio Jappelli

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant:

- **Spring 2026** Advanced Macroeconomics (Master) University of Naples Federico II
PI: Tullio Jappelli
- **Fall 2025** Macroeconomics (undergraduate) University of Naples Federico II
PIs: Tullio Jappelli, Francesco Simone Lucidi and Tommaso Oliviero

- **Fall 2023** Macroeconomics (undergraduate) University of Naples Federico II
PIs: Tullio Jappelli, Saverio Simonelli and Tommaso Oliviero

Guest Lecturer:

- **Spring 2026:** Retirement and the Demographic Transition.
Course: Economics of Pensions. PI: Chiara Lacava
- **Fall 2025:** The Jobs Act and its impact on household savings.
Course: Labor Economics (Undergraduate). PI: Roberto Nisticò
- **Spring 2025:** The Italian pension system.
Course: Public Finance (Undergraduate). PI: Carla Guerriero

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

- **June 2024** Visiting Student Researcher Scholarship – Italian Fulbright Commission
- **November 2022** PhD Scholarship - University of Naples Federico II
- **November 2020 – February 2021** Erasmus Exchange Scholarship
- **June 2019** Best Student Award, University of Naples Federico II

PRESENTATIONS, CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS (including planned)

2026: Ca' Foscari Internal Seminars, CSEF PhD Seminar, 21st Doctorissimes - Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne, HEC Liège Young Researchers Conference in Economics (HYRCE), EALE Tour 2026 - University of Naples Federico II (flash talk), 2nd Workshop on Frontiers in Measurement and Survey Methods - Università della Calabria (poster session), XXIX Workshop on Dynamic Macroeconomics - Vigo, 41st EEA Meeting - University College Dublin, 6th Sailing the Macro Workshop - Ortygia Foundation, 5th Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop

2025: Stanford Macro Lunch, NSE Summer School (poster session), 5th Sailing the Macro Workshop - Ortygia Foundation, 40th AIEL Annual Conference - Università Milano-Bicocca, 4th Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop, CSEF PhD Seminar, 23rd Brucchi Luchino Labour Economics Workshop - Università di Padova

2024: CSEF PhD Informal Seminar

ORGANIZED WORKSHOPS

- **2026:** 5th Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop
Member of the Organizing Committee and Chair of the Macro and Development Sessions
- **2025:** 4th Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop
Member of the Organizing Committee and Chair of the Macro Session
- **2024:** 3rd Naples School of Economics PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop
Member of the Organizing Committee

SKILLS

- **Languages:** English (*fluent*), Italian (*native*)
- **Programming:** Python, Matlab, Stata, L^AT_EX, Dynare, R